Phoenix United Basketball Development Club

BRIDGING FUND COORDINATOR GUIDE

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Purpose

The purpose of this guide is to assist the volunteer **Bridging Fund Coordinator** in delivering the Club's **Slam Dunk Bridging Fund** program. This role helps ensure that no junior player misses out due to financial hardship.

Your support helps make basketball more inclusive and accessible for all children. Please reach out if you have suggestions to improve this guide to **hello@bendigophoenix.org.au.**

Introduction

The Club is committed to ensuring every child can participate in basketball, regardless of financial circumstances. The Bridging Fund program supports this aim by helping families cover costs such as registration fees, uniforms, and essential equipment like a basketball.

The **Bridging Fund Coordinator** manages the confidential intake and administration process, ensuring the fund operates with fairness, transparency, and compassion while safeguarding family privacy.

This guide explains how to manage enquiries, assess eligibility, liaise with office bearers for approvals, and report fund usage with discretion and respect.

KEY RESPONSIBILITIES

Club Policy

- Provide input into the Club's Bridging Fund Policy.
- Be familiar with Club policies.
- Be familiar with the BBA Policies & Guidelines as applicable.

Confidential Family Support

- Respond sensitively and privately to referrals or applications from families, players, coaches, or the Committee.
- Maintain confidentiality at all times and treat all enquiries with empathy.

Application Process & Eligibility

- Share the Bridging Fund Application Form and assist families as needed.
- Assess eligibility using Club criteria defined in the policy:
  - Player aged between 5 and 17
  - Registered with the Club
  - Has exhausted government concessions (e.g. Active Kids)
  - Holds a valid Services Australia concession card if applicable
- After review, forward applications with recommendations to the **Treasurer and a second independent office bearer** for decision.

Disbursement & Support

- Facilitate delivery of funding support as approved (e.g. covering parts of registration or uniform cost).
- Keep families informed confidentially about the outcome and process.

Record Keeping & Privacy

- Store records securely in the club's Google Drive, with access limited to authorised office bearers.
- Record application details in de-identified form—never include personal identifiers in shared reporting.

Promotion & Awareness

- Liaise with the Social Media Coordinator to raise awareness about the Bridging Fund through newsletters, social media (through approved messaging), coach briefings, and registration letters.
- Provide families with information about external resources such as government vouchers and community support services where applicable.

Referral to External Support

- Help families access other assistance programs as needed, such as school wellbeing services or council initiatives.
- Maintain a short reference list of community supports.

GRANT MANAGEMENT AND FUTURE FUNDING

The Slam Dunk Bridging Fund is now supported by a **City of Greater Bendigo Community Grant**. The Bridging Fund Coordinator supports the Committee to ensure this grant is used in accordance with its approved purpose and helps lay the groundwork for sustainability of the fund.

Responsibilities include:

- **Work with the Treasurer** to track and report how grant funds are spent (e.g. uniforms, equipment, registration fee support).
- **Assist with reporting back to the City of Greater Bendigo**, including any required financial acquittals or usage reports.
- **Support future funding opportunities** by identifying potential local grants or community partnerships.
- **Maintain a simple usage summary** that can be shared with prospective funders or used to build grant applications.
- **Provide insights to the Committee** on emerging needs that may support the case for future funding.

Note: Grant applications and acquittals are submitted by the Club Secretary or President as the formal signatories, but the Bridging Fund Coordinator plays a key role in supplying supporting documentation and data.

REPORTING

Report to the Committee in confidence, ideally at each meeting or via written summary if unavailable:

- Number of enquiries received, applications submitted, and approved
- Total financial assistance provided
- Common barriers or patterns observed
- Suggestions for improving Fund promotion or process

Reports must never include identifiable personal details.

CONCLUSION

As Bridging Fund Coordinator, you play a critical role in making Phoenix a truly inclusive club. Your compassion, discretion, and organisation help ensure every child has the chance to participate — and that families feel supported, not judged.

Thank you for your service and dedication. You help Phoenix live its values by making sport accessible to all.

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